Sorta: Overview & How to Use

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What Sorta is

Sorta is a small website that runs on your own laptop. It sorts screenshots of Facebook posts from private dental clinics into the thesis's five content categories. It then keeps a spreadsheet of the results up to date.

You drop in screenshots of a post. A local AI reads them, picks a main category and any secondary ones, and explains why in one sentence. You check each post on the Review page and correct the AI when it is wrong. The final counts and percentages per category are ready for the thesis results chapter.

What you get out of it:

- **Post Categories.xlsx**: an Excel file with a Summary tab, an All posts tab and one tab per category. It is rewritten after every change.
- **Optional live Google Sheet**: the same tables, synced automatically so the whole group can see progress.
- **A Results page** in the app showing how many posts fall under each category.

Sorta does not collect posts from Facebook. Someone in the group still takes the screenshots by hand; Sorta handles the coding and the tallying.

How Sorta categorizes

Every post gets exactly one **main category** and up to three **"Also contains"** categories. The AI suggests both; a person on the team has the final say.

The five categories

#	Category	What it means	Typical posts
1	Oral Health Education	Main purpose is to inform about oral health, prevention, conditions or treatments	Brushing and flossing tips, myths vs facts, what a root canal is, aftercare advice

#	Category	What it means	Typical posts
2	Advertisement of Clinical Services	Promotes the clinic's services, treatments, prices, packages or promos	Promos and discounts, price lists, braces or whitening packages, "book now / message us"
3	Public Announcement	Clinic operations	Clinic hours, holiday closures, a new branch, welcoming a new dentist, outreach and dental missions
4	Patient Testimonial	Reviews, thank-yous, or patient stories presented as feedback	Star ratings, screenshots of patient comments, "Salamat po Doc!", "Hindi masakit, recommended!"
5	Miscellaneous	Fits none of the above	Holiday greetings, memes, trivia unrelated to dentistry

The number in the first column is also the keyboard shortcut on the Review page.

Decision rules (used by both the AI and reviewers)

1. **Check for a testimonial first.** If the main content is a patient's review, rating, comment, thank-you or story, it is Testimonial. This holds even if it also says "book now" or names a promo; tick Advertisement under Also contains.
2. Otherwise, pick the post's **main purpose**. Anything else it clearly includes goes under Also contains.
3. A promo, price or "book now" makes it **Advertisement**, even if it also gives a tip (tick Education under Also contains).
4. Hours, closures, moves, new staff and events are **Announcement**, even when written as a greeting.
5. Before-and-after or patient photos are **Testimonial** when they come with the patient's words or thanks. When they only showcase the clinic's work, they are **Advertisement**.
6. Use **Miscellaneous** only when nothing else fits. It is never an Also contains.

These rules are under **How to decide** on the Review page, and hovering any category shows its full definition and examples.

What the AI does with each post

- **Model:** Qwen2.5-VL 7B (`qwen2.5vl:7b`), a vision-language model that can read images. It runs through Ollama on your own computer, not in the cloud.

- **Input:** up to the first 3 screenshots of the post, shrunk to at most 1024 × 1600 pixels. Later screenshots rarely change the category.
- **Instructions:** the category definitions, examples and decision rules above, plus a list of Tagalog and Taglish feedback phrases ("Salamat po Doc", "ang galing", "sulit", "babalik ako"). It is told that colours and layout don't decide the category; only the post's message does.
- **Output, in a fixed format:** main category, Also contains, confidence (low, medium or high), a one-sentence reason, and a short transcription of the text it read.
- **Consistency:** the first attempt uses temperature 0, so the same screenshots give the same answer. If the answer is broken or the model loops, Sorta retries once with slightly different settings.
- **Speed:** about 10 seconds per post. The very first post after starting takes about 40 seconds while the model loads.

Human review

The AI's answer is a suggestion, not the final code. Every AI-sorted post goes into the **Review** queue until a person approves or changes it. Sorta records who set each category:

Set by	Reviewed	Meaning
AI	No	AI's choice, nobody has checked it yet
AI	Yes	A person checked it and agreed with the AI
You	Yes	A person changed the AI's choice

Once a person changes a post, re-running the AI never overwrites it. The Summary tab reports how many posts the AI sorted, how many a person changed, and how many were reviewed. Those numbers are useful for describing the method and the AI's agreement with human coders.

Data privacy

Screenshots and everything read from them stay on the laptop running Sorta. The only thing that ever goes online is the optional Google Sheet, and it holds codes and categories, not images or post text.

What Sorta does to protect the data

- **The AI runs offline.** Classification happens in Ollama on your own computer. No screenshot is sent to ChatGPT, Gemini or any other online service.

- **Only your laptop can open the site.** Sorta listens on `127.0.0.1` (this computer only). Someone else on the same Wi-Fi cannot open it.
- **Clinics are coded, not named.** Each clinic is saved as a code like `PAGE001` and each post as `POST001`. Sorta never asks for or stores a clinic's name.
- **Photo metadata is removed.** Every uploaded screenshot is re-saved as a clean PNG, which strips hidden EXIF and GPS data.
- **The AI redacts what it transcribes.** It is told to replace names of people and clinics, phone numbers and addresses with `[REDACTED]`, and to keep its reasons free of names. This is best-effort, so a name can still slip through; check before quoting.
- **Deleting is real.** Delete post removes the post and its screenshot files from the disk.
- **Nothing is committed to Git.** The `data` folder is excluded, so screenshots and the database are never uploaded to GitHub by accident.

Where everything is stored

All of it lives in one folder: `data` inside the Sorta folder.

File or folder	What it holds	Leaves the laptop?
`data/images/`	The screenshots, one subfolder per clinic and post	Never
`data/posts.db`	The database: codes, AI answers, final categories, review status, transcribed text	Never
`data/Post Categories.xlsx`	The Excel results, including the text the AI read	Only if you share the file
`data/settings.json`	The Google Sheet link and its secret token	Never

What the Google Sheet receives

Sent to Google	Not sent
Clinic and post codes	Screenshots
Main category and Also contains	The text the AI read from posts
Set by (AI or You) and Reviewed	Anything that names a clinic
AI confidence and its one-sentence reason	

Sent to Google	Not sent
Upload date and time	

The Apps Script holds a secret token, so only your copy of Sorta can write to the sheet. The deployment must say "Who has access: Anyone" so Sorta can reach it, but the sheet itself stays private. Share it only with the research group.

What the group still has to do

- **Keep the clinic key private.** If you list which clinic is `PAGE001`, keep that list off the shared sheet and out of group chats.
- **Treat the laptop and the Excel file as research data.** The screenshots still show names and faces, and the Excel file contains transcribed text. Use a password on the laptop and don't post the `data` folder in group chats.
- **Back up the `data` folder** to a private drive or USB. If it is lost, the screenshots and review work are lost too.

Getting started

The first setup takes one-time installs plus a model download of several GB. After that, starting Sorta is a double-click.

One-time setup

1. **Install Node.js** (version 22 or newer, the LTS download) from nodejs.org.
2. **Install Ollama** from ollama.com. This is the program that runs the AI on your laptop.
3. **Download the AI model.** Open Command Prompt and run `ollama pull qwen2.5vl:7b`. Wait for it to finish; it is a large download.
4. **Get the Sorta folder** onto the laptop, for example by copying it from a USB drive.

Every time you use it

1. Make sure **Ollama is running** (start it from the Start menu if needed).
2. Double-click **Start Sorta.bat** in the Sorta folder. The first run installs its parts, which takes about a minute.
3. Your browser opens **http://127.0.0.1:3000**. Keep the black window open while you work.
4. Check the badge at the top right. It should say **AI ready**.
5. When you're done, close the black window to stop Sorta.

Badge says	What to do
AI ready	Nothing; you're set
AI off	Start Ollama from the Start menu
AI not downloaded	Run `ollama pull qwen2.5vl:7b`

You can still upload posts while the AI is off. They wait as unsorted and sort themselves once Ollama is running.

How to use it

The work runs in four steps: upload screenshots, let the AI sort them, review each post, then read off the results. The top menu has one page per step: **Posts**, **Review**, **Results** and **Google Sheets**.

1. Upload posts (Posts page)

1. Under **Clinic**, pick the clinic you're working on. For a new clinic, choose **New clinic** and Sorta gives it the next code (`PAGE001` , `PAGE002` , …).
2. Choose how the screenshots are grouped:
   - **Each screenshot is a post**: one image per post. This is the default.
   - **All screenshots are one post**: for a long post or a carousel captured in several images. Upload them together, in order.
3. Drag the screenshots onto the drop box, click **browse**, or paste one with **Ctrl+V**. PNG, JPG, WebP and GIF work, up to 20 images per post.
4. Each post gets the next post code for that clinic (`POST001` , `POST002` , …).

Write down which clinic is which code, privately (see Data privacy).

2. Let the AI sort them

Sorting starts by itself, one post at a time; the list shows **Sorting…** and how many are left. Each card then shows the category, any Also contains, and the AI's confidence. Use the category chips above the list to filter, and the icons on the right to switch between card and list view.

If a post shows **Couldn't sort · Retry**, click it to try again.

3. Review every post (Review page)

The number next to **Review** in the menu is how many AI-sorted posts nobody has checked yet. Open it and go through them, oldest first.

1. Look at the screenshot. Use the arrow keys to flip between images of the same post.
2. Read **why the AI chose** its category and its confidence.
3. If it is right, press **Enter** (Approve & next).
4. If it is wrong, press **1–5** to pick the right main category, toggle any **Also contains**, then press **Enter** (Save & next).
5. Not sure? Click **Skip** and come back to it later.

Open **How to decide** for the decision rules, and **Text the AI read** to see its transcription. A post uploaded by mistake can be removed with **Delete post**. You can also click any post on the Posts page to open it and change it again later.

4. Read the results (Results page)

The Results page shows the number of posts and clinics sorted and the share of each category. It also shows how many posts were kept as the AI sorted them, and how many a person checked. Click **Download Excel** (or **Export** at the top) to get the spreadsheet.

Optional: share live results through Google Sheets

One person, ideally the one who owns the group's Google account, sets this up once on the **Google Sheets** page:

1. Create a blank sheet at sheets.new and keep it private.
2. In the sheet, open **Extensions → Apps Script**, delete what is there, and paste the script from Sorta's Google Sheets page (use **Copy script**). Save.
3. Click **Deploy → New deployment → Web app**. Set **Execute as: Me** and **Who has access: Anyone**, then Deploy and allow access when Google asks.
4. Copy the **Web app URL**, paste it into Sorta and click **Connect**.

After that, the sheet updates a few seconds after every change, and the **Sheet** button at the top opens it.

Understanding the results

Sorta gives two kinds of counts per category, and they answer different questions. **Posts (primary)** counts each post once, under its main category, so the shares add up to 100%. **Posts containing it** counts a post under its main category and everything it also contains, so the shares add up to more than 100%.

Spreadsheet tabs

The Excel file (`data/Post Categories.xlsx`) and the Google Sheet have the same tabs:

Tab	What's on it
Summary	Posts per category (primary) and %, posts containing each category and %, total sorted, plus how many posts the AI sorted, a person changed, and a person reviewed
All posts	One row per post, including ones not sorted yet
Education, Advertisement, Announcement, Testimonial, Miscellaneous	Only the posts whose main category is that one

Columns on the post tabs

Column	Meaning
Clinic	Clinic code, e.g. `PAGE001`
Post	Post code, e.g. `POST001`
Category	Final main category, or "Not sorted yet"
Also contains	Secondary categories, separated by semicolons
Set by	AI, or You if a person changed it
Reviewed	Yes once a person approved or changed it
AI confidence	low, medium or high
AI reason	The AI's one-sentence explanation
Screenshots	Link that opens the screenshot on this laptop (Excel only)
Uploaded	Date and time the post was added
Text read from the post	The AI's transcription, with names redacted (Excel only)

The Excel file is rewritten after every change. If it is open in Excel at that moment, it can't be updated: close it and it updates on the next change. Use **Download Excel** if you want a copy to work in.

Tips, FAQ and troubleshooting

Can several of us use it at the same time? Each copy of Sorta keeps its own data on its own laptop, and the copies don't merge. The simplest setup is one laptop that everyone codes on. If you split the work across laptops, give each person a separate range of clinics so codes like `PAGE001` don't clash.

Does it need internet? No, apart from the one-time installs and the optional Google Sheet sync.

How long does sorting take? About 10 seconds per post, and about 40 seconds for the first post after starting while the AI loads.

Should we trust the AI? Treat it as a first pass. Review every post, and pay extra attention to ones marked low confidence.

Problem	Fix
Black window says "Is Node.js installed?"	Install Node.js from nodejs.org, then double-click Start Sorta.bat again
Badge says AI off	Start Ollama from the Start menu
Badge says AI not downloaded	Run `ollama pull qwen2.5vl:7b` in Command Prompt
"The local AI took too long"	Click Retry; the first post after starting is the slowest
A post shows Couldn't sort	Click Retry, or pick the category yourself on the Review page
"… already exists" when uploading	That clinic and post code is taken; pick the right clinic and try again
Excel file isn't updating	Close it in Excel; it updates on the next change
Google says "asked for a sign-in"	In the Apps Script deployment, set Who has access to Anyone and deploy again
"The script's token doesn't match"	Copy the script from Sorta's Google Sheets page again and redeploy
Browser page won't load	Make sure the black window is still open; if it closed, double-click Start Sorta.bat